

SAFE | SAFE-15

Program Board and Dependency Register

Features, milestones and cross-team dependencies plotted across the planning interval

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Program Board and Dependency Register
Document reference	SAFE-15-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Release Train Engineer
Approver	Not applicable — agreed by the ART at the confidence vote
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
SAFE-12	PI Planning Facilitation Pack	The event that produces this
SAFE-17	ROAM Risk Log	Companion output
SAFE-21	ART Sync Agenda	Where this is reviewed
MSP-12	Programme Dependency Register	Programme-level equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Records the output of PI planning as a visible plan — which features land in which iteration for which team, the milestones and external events the PI must respect, and every dependency between teams with an agreed delivery point.
Framework	SAFe — Agile Product Delivery — PI Planning outputs
Created when	During PI planning day two
Reviewed / updated	At every ART sync throughout the PI
Owner	Release Train Engineer
Approver	Not applicable — agreed by the ART at the confidence vote
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	The physical board is the artefact during the event. This document is the durable record and the working register used at ART sync.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Every dependency has both a providing and a consuming team, and both have agreed
- Dependencies have a needed-by iteration, not just a PI
- Milestones include external events the ART does not control — audits, regulatory dates, vendor releases
- It is updated at every ART sync, not left as a planning-day snapshot
- Red dependencies are escalated the same week they turn red

Contents

Document control..... 2

 Version history..... 2

 Reviewers..... 2

 Approval..... 2

 Related products..... 3

How to use this template..... 4

 Quality criteria..... 4

1. PI details..... 6

2. Feature placement..... 6

3. Milestones and events..... 7

4. Dependency register..... 8

5. Cross-ART and external dependencies..... 17

6. Dependency escalation log..... 18

1. PI details

Field	Detail
ART	<i>Helios AI Platform ART</i>
PI number	<i>PI 4 — 01 Oct 2026 to 24 Dec 2026</i>
PI start / end	<i>Helios AI Platform ART</i>
Iterations	<i>Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail</i>
IP iteration	<i>Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above</i>
Confidence vote	<i>4 out of 5 — average across 84 participants</i>

2. Feature placement

Which team delivers which feature, and in which iteration it completes.

Feature ID	Feature	Team	Iter 1	Iter 2	Iter 3	Iter 4	Iter 5	IP	Status
FE-101	<i>Fair-share quota enforcement across three tenants</i>	<i>Scheduler team</i>		X	X				<i>In progress</i>
FE-102	<i>Pre-emption policy for low-priority training jobs</i>	<i>Scheduler team</i>			X	X			<i>In progress</i>
FE-103	<i>Per-tenant consumption metering and monthly export</i>	<i>Platform services team</i>	X	X					<i>Done</i>
FE-104	<i>Container image signing in the build pipeline</i>	<i>Supply chain team</i>	X	X				X	<i>Done</i>
FE-105	<i>Admission control refusing unsigned images</i>	<i>Supply chain team</i>		X	X				<i>In progress</i>
FE-106	<i>Firmware attestation at node admission</i>	<i>Supply chain team</i>				X	X		<i>Not started</i>

Feature ID	Feature	Team	Iter 1	Iter 2	Iter 3	Iter 4	Iter 5	IP	Status
FE-107	Self-service environment request portal	Developer experience team			X	X	X		Not started
FE-108	Notebook workspace with GPU attach and detach	Developer experience team				X	X	X	Not started
FE-109	GPU telemetry at 10-second resolution into observability	Observability team	X	X					Done
FE-110	Dataset version pinning in the training pipeline	ML platform team			X	X			Not started

3. Milestones and events

Include everything the PI must plan around, whether or not the ART controls it.

Ref	Milestone / event	Type	Date	Iteration	Owner	Impact on plan
MS-01	e.g. External penetration test window	e.g. Assurance	12 Mar 2026	Carried forward from the Tranche 1 lessons register	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing
MS-02	Pilot cluster of 256 GPUs live in DXB-1 hall A	Delivery	28 Aug 2026	Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Training throughput approximately 9% below the business case assumption
MS-03	Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review and Tranche 2 funding gate	Gate	18 Sep 2026	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Contingency drawdown of 12% against the AED 9.4m held

Ref	Milestone / event	Type	Date	Iteration	Owner	Impact on plan
MS-04	Hall B structural strengthening complete	Delivery	15 Dec 2026	Subject to closure of ISS-003 before multi-tenant go-live	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	On-call rota cannot be sustained beyond a 5x8 model at handover
MS-05	Utility uplift to 6 MVA energised	External	30 Nov 2026	Reviewed monthly at the Programme Board	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Hall A capacity capped at 1,536 GPUs until resolved
MS-06	Hall A scaled to 1,024 GPUs and accepted	Delivery	26 Feb 2027	Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Critical path delay of up to ten weeks and a quarter of deferred benefit
MS-07	Platform v1.0 released — scheduling, quota, observability, image supply chain	Delivery	31 Mar 2027	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing
MS-08	Independent security assurance and penetration test passed	Assurance	23 Apr 2027	Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint	L. Haddad, CISO	Training throughput approximately 9% below the business case assumption

4. Dependency register

The heart of the board. A dependency without an agreed needed-by date and a named owner on both sides is not a dependency, it is a hope.

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
DEP-001	Utility connection uplift to 6 MVA energised at DXB-1	Facilities (external — utility provider)	Facilities (external — utility provider)	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	30 Nov 2026	Not yet	Amber	No	Utility works ordered; energisation date confirmed but not

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										ot co nt ra ct u all y co m m itt e d
DEP-002	400G leaf-spine fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated in hall A	WS3 Network fabric	WS3 Network fabric	WS4 Platform and orchestration	WS4 Platform and orchestration	15 Dec 2026	Yes	Green	No	O n pl a n; b e nc h m ar k g at e sc h e d ul

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										ed
DEP-003	Identity platform provides workload identity federation for cluster service accounts	Enterprise Identity Programme	Enterprise Identity Programme	WS6 Security and compliance	WS6 Security and compliance	31 Oct 2026	Not yet	Red	Yes	Identity programme has been prioritised the federation

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										pic; escalated to the portfolio Board
DEP-004	Parallel filesystem storage tier accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	WS5 MLOps and developer experience	WS5 MLOps and developer experience	20 Jan 2027	Yes	Green	No	Benchmark plan agreed with

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										th the ve n d or
DEP-005	Service operations liquid-cooling runbook and two live drills completed	WS7 Service operations and support	WS7 Service operations and support	Hall A production handover	Hall A production handover	28 Feb 2027	Not yet	Amber	No	R u n b o o k d r a f t e d ; d r i l l d a t e s n o t y e t b o o k e d w i t h

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										the F M provider
DEP-006	Chargeback rate card approved by the Programme Board	Finance	Finance	WS8 Adoption and business change	WS8 Adoption and business change	24 Sep 2026	Not yet	Red	Yes	Second deferral; blocking FY 27 businesses unit b

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										u d g e t i n g
DEP-007	Data classification completed for the three pilot training corpora	Data Governance function	Data Governance function	WS5 MLOps and developer experience	WS5 MLOps and developer experience	26 Sep 2026	Not yet	Amber	No	T w o o f t h r e e c o m p l e t e
DEP-008	Penetration test findings from the pilot closed and retested	WS6 Security and compliance	WS6 Security and compliance	Multi-tenant go-live	Multi-tenant go-live	31 Oct 2026	Not yet	Amber	No	O n e c r i t i c a l f i n d i n g o p

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										en; re test booked
DEP-009	Structural strengthening of hall B rows 1 to 8 complete	WS1 Facilities and power	WS1 Facilities and power	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	15 Dec 2026	Yes	Green	No	Contractor mobilised
DEP-010	Observability platform ingesting GPU telemetry at 10-second resolution	Enterprise Observability service	Enterprise Observability service	WS7 Service operations and support	WS7 Service operations and support	31 Jan 2027	Yes	Green	No	Exporter agreed; cap

Ref	Description	Providing team	Provider owner	Consuming team	Consumer owner	Needed by (iter)	Committed ?	Status	Escalated	Notes
										activity uplift funded by the programme

5. Cross-ART and external dependencies

Dependencies outside this train — other ARTs, suppliers, shared services, other portfolios.

Ref	Description	External party	Contact	Needed by	Agreed?	Escalation route	Status
DEP-001	Utility connection uplift to 6 MVA energised at DXB-1	Facilities (external — utility provider)	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead	30 Nov 2026	Not yet	No	Amber
DEP-	400G leaf-spine fabric commissioned	WS3 Network fabric	T. Nakamura,	15 Dec 2026	Yes	No	Green

Ref	Description	External party	Contact	Needed by	Agreed?	Escalation route	Status
002	and NCCL-validated in hall A		Chief Platform Architect				
DEP-003	Identity platform provides workload identity federation for cluster service accounts	Enterprise Identity Programme	B. Oyelaran, Quality and Assurance Lead	31 Oct 2026	Not yet	Yes	Red
DEP-004	Parallel filesystem storage tier accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead	20 Jan 2027	Yes	No	Green
DEP-005	Service operations liquid-cooling runbook and two live drills completed	WS7 Service operations and support	H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	28 Feb 2027	Not yet	No	Amber
DEP-006	Chargeback rate card approved by the Programme Board	Finance	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	24 Sep 2026	Not yet	Yes	Red
DEP-007	Data classification completed for the three pilot training corpora	Data Governance function	M. Verity, Head of P3O	26 Sep 2026	Not yet	No	Amber
DEP-008	Penetration test findings from the pilot closed and retested	WS6 Security and compliance	V. Chandra, Product Management	31 Oct 2026	Not yet	No	Amber

6. Dependency escalation log

Date	Dependency ref	Issue	Escalated to	Resolution	Closed
30 Nov 2026	DEP-001	Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	Liquid-cooled high-density compute at 60 kW per rack	18 Sep 2026
15 Dec 2026	DEP-002	Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier	WS4 Platform and orchestration	Per-tenant consumption metering and chargeback	Open

Date	Dependency ref	Issue	Escalated to	Resolution	Closed
31 Oct 2026	DEP-003	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer	WS6 Security and compliance	Cross-hall workload failover	26 Feb 2027
20 Jan 2027	DEP-004	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027	WS5 MLOps and developer experience	Experiment lineage and reproducibility	18 Sep 2026
28 Feb 2027	DEP-005	Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028	Hall A production handover	Self-service training environment provisioning	Open
24 Sep 2026	DEP-006	Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration	WS8 Adoption and business change	Signed container image supply chain	26 Feb 2027